

Application Software -- Guided Notes ANSWER KEY

Unit tp-3.2 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. FC0-U71 3.2 | N10-008 FC0-U71 3.2

For instructor use / distribute after students complete the notes.

Question 1

Application software is designed to help users perform _____ tasks, as opposed to _____ software (like the OS) which manages hardware. Common categories include _____ software (Word, Docs), _____ software (Firefox, Chrome), and _____ software (Photoshop, Premiere).

Answer: Specific (productive); system; productivity (word processing); web browser; creative (multimedia).

Question 2

_____ software requires installation to a local storage device and runs using the local CPU and RAM. _____ software (SaaS) runs in a web browser and requires no local installation -- processing occurs on a _____ server. The advantage of web-based apps is accessibility from _____ device with a browser.

Answer: Locally installed; web-based; remote; any.

Question 3

A _____ is a set of programs sold together, such as Microsoft 365 (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook). _____ software is provided at no charge. _____ is initially free but requires payment to unlock full features. _____ is software that has been permanently made free by its original developer.

Answer: Software suite; freeware; freemium (shareware); abandonware.

Question 4

_____ source software provides users access to the source code and the freedom to use, modify, and distribute it. The Linux kernel is an example. _____ source software does not provide the source code and restricts copying and modification. Windows and macOS are examples.

Answer: Open; closed (proprietary).

Question 5

Business software categories include: _____ (stores and queries structured data), _____ (tracks stock and orders), _____ (manages customer interactions), and _____ (tracks financial records). Modern businesses often rely on _____ versions of these delivered as SaaS.

Answer: Database management system (DBMS); inventory management; CRM (Customer Relationship Management); accounting software; cloud.

Question 6

Collaboration software allows multiple users to work together remotely. Examples include _____ (real-time document co-editing), _____ (team messaging and file sharing), and _____ (video meetings). These tools depend on _____ connectivity and typically sync changes via _____.

Answer: Google Docs or Microsoft 365; Slack or Teams; Zoom or Teams; internet; cloud servers.

Question 7

Vertical software is designed for a specific _____ (e.g., dental practice management, point-of-sale for retail). Horizontal software is designed for _____ industries (e.g., word processors, spreadsheets). Vertical software is often more _____ and less flexible, but better suited to the specific _____.

Answer: Industry; any (general); expensive; workflow.

Question 8 -- Real World Application

REAL WORLD: A small restaurant owner asks you whether they should buy desktop accounting software like QuickBooks Desktop or use a subscription-based cloud version like QuickBooks Online. They have one computer, limited IT knowledge, and need to access the financials occasionally from their phone while at the market. Which would you recommend and give three specific reasons.

Answer: Recommend QuickBooks Online (cloud/SaaS). Reason 1 -- Mobile access: they can access their financials from any device with a browser -- including their phone at the market -- without VPN or special setup. Reason 2 -- No maintenance: cloud version automatically updates and backs up data on the vendor servers; no user action required. A non-technical owner should not be responsible for local backups and updates. Reason 3 -- Disaster recovery: if the one desktop computer fails or is stolen, desktop software data could be lost; cloud data is stored remotely and accessible immediately from another device. The subscription cost is offset by not needing IT support for updates and recovery.